

M08 RESTORATIVE PROGRAMMING | O (MAX : 1 PT)

Intent : Support access to programs that promote restoration and relief from mental fatigue or stress.

Summary : This WELL feature requires projects to develop ongoing programming for occupants that is focused on relaxation, restoration or mindfulness, such as meditation or mindful movement.

Issue : Workplace stress is incredibly common. In the European Union, for example, an estimated one in three workers experience work-related stress.¹ Exposure to stressful work conditions is associated with poor mental and physical health.² Highly stressed employees are at risk for numerous negative outcomes, including decreased productivity, greater absenteeism, increased occupational injury and higher overall medical expenditures.³⁻⁵

Solutions : Introducing mindfulness into the workplace has been shown to lower employee stress, as well as improve focus, clarity of thinking, decision-making and emotional intelligence.^{6,7} Meditation interventions targeting workers have been found to be effective at reducing work-associated stress, depression, anxiety and burnout, as well as improving mood and sleep quality.⁸⁻¹¹ A recent systematic review concluded that mindfulness meditation can help reduce negative dimensions of psychological stress, including improving anxiety, depression, pain, stress and overall mental health.¹² Mindfulness-based stress reduction, a widely disseminated and frequently used practice, has been shown to reduce symptoms of stress, depression and anxiety, and enhance self-esteem, body image, mood and coping with other health problems, such as chronic pain, fatigue, stress and insomnia.¹³⁻¹⁵ Mindfulness-based practices, whether formal or informal, can help improve employee focus and productivity, support stress management and reduce employer costs through improvements to overall health and well-being.⁷⁻¹¹

PART 1 PROVIDE RESTORATIVE PROGRAMMING (MAX : 1 PT)

For All Spaces:

At least two of the following are offered to all eligible employees at no cost or subsidized by at least 50%:

- a. Mindfulness training course (e.g., eight-week mindfulness-based stress reduction course (MBSR)) offered live, either in-person or virtually, by a qualified mindfulness instructor at least twice a year, that meets the following:
 1. Defines mindfulness and its component parts.
 2. Covers relevant research on mindfulness.
 3. Teaches both formal practices (e.g., mindfulness meditation, yoga postures) and informal practices (e.g., mindful eating, mindful listening) that can be applied during the workday.
- b. Mindfulness programming (e.g., guided meditation, yoga) offered live, either in-person or virtually, at least once a week in a designated quiet zone.
- c. Digital mindfulness offerings (e.g., guided meditation application). Employees have unlimited access to at least one digital offering and access to at least one designated quiet zone.

Note : Refer to feature S01 Sound Mapping, Part 1: Label Acoustical Zones for all designated quiet zones.

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